Light Spinner's Folly

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/43398867.

Rating:	Teen And Up Audiences
Archive Warning:	No Archive Warnings Apply
Category:	Other
Fandom:	She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)
Relationships:	Adora & Catra & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Castaspella & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)
Characters:	Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra)
Additional Tags:	shadow weaver as a double agent, alter ego, conflicting emotions, Sacrifices, References to Canon, but in this one SW survives, 5 first Spotify wrapped songs made into a fic challenge, Thanks Twitter
Language:	English
Series:	Part 6 of Path 3
Stats:	Published: 2022-12-03 Completed: 2022-12-07 Words: 5,630 Chapters: 5/5

Light Spinner's Folly

by Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

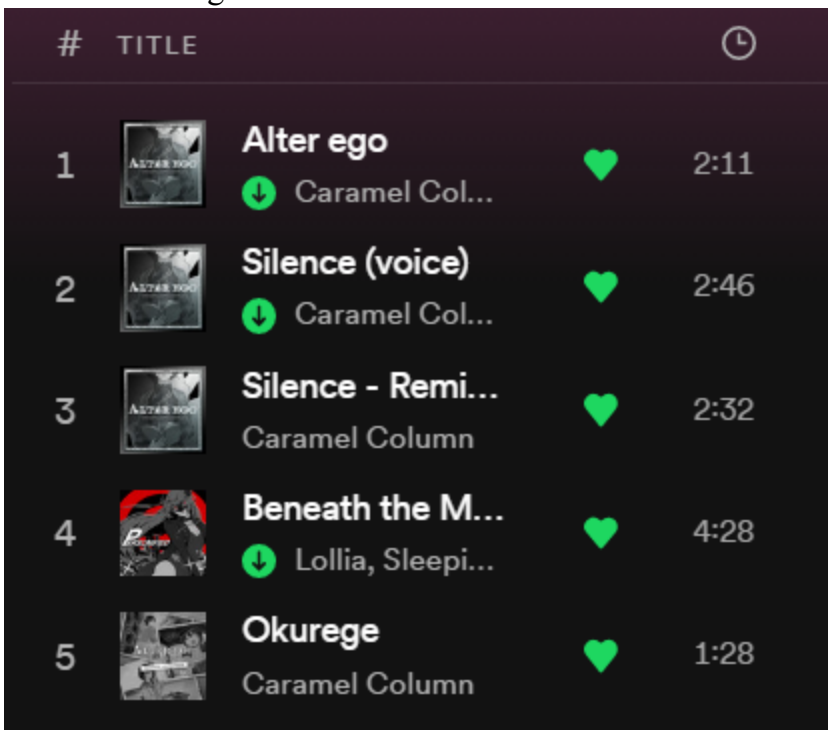
Summary

Split between being Shadow Weaver and Light Spinner, the sorceress tries to help the Rebellion while keeping Hordak's suspicions away from her. But her plan will prove to be more than she can handle.

Sacrifices will have to be done, and the woman will be forced to choose: Is she Shadow Weaver? Or is she Light Spinner?

Notes

Well, this whole thing was inspired by a tweet suggesting writing a 5-chapters fanfic where each chapter is named like the first 5 songs of our Spotify wrapped list. And so I had to do it! Here's said songs:



The idea was suggested by a friend, also in twt, and I suppose it was too good to pass, so... heh XD

Well, I hope you enjoy this little thing!

- Inspired by The tweet that inspired writing this! by Jen

Alter Ego

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It had all been a farce since day one.

Her plan was more than risky, but she was sure it would work.

And so she put her life on the line and attempted the Spell of Obtainment on her own. It backfired, and her life became a living nightmare.

She immediately left Mystacor and went to join the Horde, thinking she'd be able to take it down from the inside.

But she couldn't have imagined her plan would take so many years… or so much sacrifice.

—On your feet, soldier— she ordered. —Quick!

—Yes, Shadow Weaver.

The kid, not older than sixteen perhaps, slowly stood up, face red from the hit against the ground. One of his fellow cadets had landed a kick and thrown them to the floor before they could react.

Shadow Weaver had supervised these kids since the Horde took them in, and it was her duty to train them to be soldiers to fight against the Rebellion.

And so she did: she had them train for hours, be punished for failing, and rewarded for succeeding.

When her mask was on, that was all she had to think about.

No mercy, no compassion.

Shadow Weaver is but an immutable commanding officer, and her cadets should heed her every order or suffer the consequences.

—Training has ended for today. It was far less than acceptable. You will repeat it tomorrow and make it *perfect*.

She promptly retired to her chambers and slammed the door shut behind her.

Mask off, she took a deep breath.

About two years had passed since she “joined” the Horde, and nothing had gone according to her plan. All her ideas, her attempts at sabotaging the Horde or contacting the Rebellion to filter information, all had failed.

It was hard not to give up. But Light Spinner was sure there were no more choices. Nothing else worked, the princesses and their alliance weren’t enough…

She *had* to do this.

She laid down on her bed, eyes closed, and sighed.

She missed Mystacor so much.

She missed teaching magic.

Missed her pupils and her own studies.

But she had to keep in mind why she was doing all of this.
For Etheria…

Another year went by, and another…

Her cadets became better but were still far from perfect, and it caught Hordak’s attention.

—…An absolute failure— he snarled from the massive screen in front of her.

—I assure you, these kids are just too lazy. They will become formidable soldiers with more training.

—Or perhaps you’re not doing your job right, Shadow Weaver.

—I promise, my Lord, that I’m doing my best. But one cannot do miracles. I need more time.

—Years without progress. How much time do you need!?

—The necessary if you want results!

—Do not raise your tone, commanding officer! And do not talk back again!

—Yes, Lord Hordak. Excuse me.

Right after, the screen through which he was addressing Shadow Weaver turned off, and the woman was left alone in the Black Garnet’s chamber.

She took a deep breath while unfastening her mask and exhaled slowly.

What had she gotten herself into?

This was her brilliant plan?

Light Spinner little by little lost hope in herself.

There wasn't much she could do, and the more she followed orders, the less she helped her people as intended.

And now? Now, she depended on this runestone to keep her powers working, if not even to keep her heart working too.

Just what had she done…

As more years went by, the war continued to rage on, and the Horde won more battles and territory.

Several times, Rebellion soldiers were captured, kept prisoners for a while, interrogated, and finally disposed of. And no matter what she did, Light Spinner simply couldn't help them.

There were no reasons for Shadow Weaver to ever interrogate any of them, no one would expect to see her anywhere near the cells, and she thought it gave her a perfect opportunity to go plot with them their escape.

But it turned out to be the exact opposite.

Every time she tried to go down to the prison cells, something would happen and interrupt her plans. Even with her magic,

she was unable to simply blend into the shadows and appear there because, as soon as she arrived at a cell, the soldier in question would start screaming in horror.

Countless times they had called the guards' attention, and she had to flee before she could reveal her complicity. What's more, whenever she was lucky enough to appear in front of a braver soldier, they simply wouldn't trust her.

At all.

How would she devise a plan to free them if they wouldn't believe her!?

Her strategies had backfired splendidly, and nothing she could do was enough to fix things…

Perhaps it was time to give up, was it not?

One day, someone was captured and considered one of the Horde's greatest victories: the King of Bright Moon, Micah.

He was known as the King, as a commander of the Rebellion, as the greatest sorcerer of Etheria, and as Light Spinner's star pupil.

If someone could perhaps, and only perhaps, believe her, it was him.

She had to try. Maybe he would place a little bit of trust in her and allow her to plot his escape.

But it wouldn't be easy.

With his reputation, "Shadow Weaver" would have to prove to Hordak that she was no longer "Light Spinner". While, at the same time, she would have to prove to Micah that "Shadow Weaver" was nothing but a mask…

And so, as if anticipating her move, Lord Hordak called for Shadow Weaver to be the one who interrogated king Micah.

The same night he was put inside his cell, the woman presented herself in front of him, accompanied by two soldiers.

Just perfect.

—Rise, prisoner— one of the soldiers ordered.

The King, hands tied in front of him, made an effort to stand and looked up at the shadowy figure that had entered his cell.

He couldn't recognize her.

—Hello, Micah— she let out, hoping her voice would be enough.

And it was.

She could see it in his eyes.

He recognized Light Spinner under the mask of Shadow Weaver.

Chapter End Notes

Well, this was chapter 1! See you tomorrow with Chapter 2!!

I hope you enjoyed!

Silence - Part 1

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

—Hello, Micah.

It couldn't be… Could it?

The King stared at the white sockets of her mask in utter disbelief, speechless, and gulped nervously, telling himself it couldn't be happening.

—No… You…— he hesitated, suddenly breathless, and taking a step back. —You died…

—I didn't.

—It consumed you! You-you cast that forbidden spell and it killed you!

—Silence, prisoner!— one of the soldiers accompanying Shadow Weaver yelled, raising their electric baton at him.

—Enough. I can handle him— she stated, lifting a hand in front of the soldier. —You both, leave— she ordered. —I shall carry out the interrogation on my own.

The soldiers exchanged a concerned look and didn't move.

—But…

—I said *leave*!— she barked, being as scary as Shadow Weaver could be. —I will *not* repeat myself!

After exchanging yet another confused look, both soldiers saluted and retired. They would wait outside the cell until she was done, meaning she'd have to be extremely careful.

But she had studied the prison and its cells for a very long time now. She knew how much could be heard from outside, how the cells' doors and cuffs worked, and how little the soldiers standing guard would be able to hear as long as they kept their voice tone moderate.

—What do you want from me?— Micah asked, inevitably scared.

—A moment.

—What?

—Listen to me— she began, and carefully took off her mask. —I don't have much time, and it's not safe for either of us.

She held her mask with one hand and looked at him with a sorrowful expression. Despite the cell's poor illumination, her scarred face was visible enough, and he instinctively took yet another step back.

Once again, he was in utter disbelief, refusing to accept this was Light Spinner in front of him. It simply couldn't be. How had his mentor become… *this*.

—Do-don't come any closer— he stammered.

—Please, Micah. Listen to me.

—No, no! You… are a traitor!

—Micah…

—I won't believe a word you say!

—I'm just trying to help you. I can get you out of this place…

—Why would you!?

—Because…— she began, yelling angrily, but had to interrupt herself to calm down. After taking a look back at the door of the cell behind her, she spoke to him again, lowering her tone, —Because I'm on your side!

—No— he shook his head. —You betrayed us…

—I only… *pretended*, Micah. *Trust me*— she insisted. —I only need you to give me *something*, anything that can justify keeping you here until I break you out— she explained.

But he immediately scoffed.

—So I'm supposed to betray the Rebellion!? No.

—Just give me something!

—I will *not* help you!

—They will dispose of you within a week!

—Then so be it! I am *not* a traitor!

They glared at each other for a moment before Shadow Weaver gave up.

However, before putting her mask back on, she told him —I mean it, Micah. I want to save you…

She finally fixed her mask in place and turned around resignedly, ready to leave.

—Wait— he stopped her. She halted but didn't turn around. —I- Tell them I will reveal the locations of strategic outposts.

—When?

—When they free the rest of my battalion.

—Only two dozen soldiers were captured— she clarified, barely turning her head back.

—Then free them and I will speak— he demanded.

Without a word, Shadow Weaver walked out of the cell, neither confirming nor denying she would tell Hordak about his offer.

But he knew she would.

He had decided to trust her just enough to save his people.

Shadow Weaver left the prison without talking to anyone else, mind reeling, her tension dissimulated by her mask and her proud posture.

He really trusted her, and she'd get sufficient time to break him free.

At long last…

It was all finally working out for her…

A couple of days later, all the captured Rebellion soldiers were freed, as per Shadow Weaver's "strategic suggestion", and returned to their homes, some of them with a warning about the price the King had to pay for their freedom.

And so, Micah revealed where such outposts could be found.

Without much detail, the soldiers approached the spots ready to fight, yet found they had been abandoned before the Horde arrived.

All of them were strategic positions the Rebellion had captured over the years, yet they didn't doubt a single moment and deserted them as soon as the returned soldiers alerted everyone.

Oh, but perhaps… perhaps that had been a bit of a risky move from Light Spinner, hadn't it?

Finding all those outposts abandoned could only mean one of two things: either the King was giving them locations of old outposts, meaning he wasn't holding his end of the deal, *or* there was a mole.

And Hordak didn't think twice.

—*Please*, illuminate me, Shadow Weaver— he began, seething. —How exactly is the information you've gotten so… *insufficient*!?

—But, my Lord. Haven’t you gotten ahold of strategic locations that used to belong to the Rebellion?

—Locations that happened to be forsaken… Meaning they hadn't been working lately, or that they *knew* we were coming— he countered. —No useful documents were found. Nothing to reveal their strategies. No supplies either. These victories are *meaningless*.

—Perhaps they saw the Horde marching towards them and fled.

—If these locations are as important as that prisoner insists, then *why* haven’t they fought for them!? Something is *wrong*.

—I understand, Lord Hordak. But it doesn’t matter as long as…

—It matters if I say so!— he interrupted, hitting the arm of his throne with a fist. —There is something off, Shadow Weaver. And unless you find out exactly *what* that prisoner is hiding, you can say goodbye to all your privileges. Because if he isn’t the one providing faulty information…—, he squinted, —Then it must be *you*.

—Lord Hordak…

—No more excuses. Get me new, *useful*, information or dispose of him— he ordered. —I am tired of this game…

Chapter End Notes

That was all for chapter 2! I know, they are quite short...

Well, see you tomorrow with the next chapter!
And I hope you liked it!

Silence - Part 2

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

He had to leave that same night.

She had gotten him all the time available, and now it was impossible to delay the inevitable any longer.

—Come! Now! There's no time to lose!— she ordered Micah, slashing through the cuffs around his wrists. —Leave now!

—But…

He couldn't finish speaking because, as soon as his hands were free, she blended into the shadows and used her magic to have the door to the cell fail.

It was his chance, but he was on his own.

He hesitantly stepped out, looking out for guards, but they seemed to be nowhere to be found.

So he ran.

Light Spinner promptly returned to her chambers and took off her mask. Sure she was safe inside her room, she went to a basin she had procured for herself, and immediately cast the pulse spell to keep an eye on Micah.

He was running down the prison, looking for the way out, and trying his best to avoid the guards. Until he couldn't keep himself hidden anymore and had to start blasting left and right.

Thanks to his magic, the King managed to reach a door and rushed outside, only to be swarmed by several squads of soldiers.

Light Spinner cursed under her breath and pushed herself away from the basin. Pacing back and forth, she began muttering angrily, considering whether to help further or leave him to fend for himself.

But what could she do!?

There was absolutely nothing safe enough to give him an edge without exposing herself.

Sending her shadow spies would be far too stupid; it would be evident that she had freed him. And any kind of spells she could think of, anything sufficiently stealthy, would require for her to be close enough to see the whole situation with her own eyes.

Perhaps she should simply go there and help from the shadows, no?

Decided, she dismissed the Pulse spell and approached the door of her room, ready to leave.

But someone knocked before she could touch it.

—Who is it!??

—Lord Hordak requires your presence immediately— a soldier replied.

Well, there goes her plan once again.

She opened the door once her mask was back on, and stepped outside.

—Alright then, I shall go.

When she arrived in front of Hordak, who was again sitting on his throne, she bowed and silently waited for him to speak.

—Shadow Weaver— he began. —Care to explain how *your prisoner* has escaped his cell!?

—My Lord, I don't understand. Has the King escaped!?— she asked, with fake incredulity. —How!? When!?

—Just now, he attempted to escape the prison— Hordak replied, squinting at her. *Attempted*. —Are you not aware?

—Lord Hordak, ho-how would I know?

—So you had no participation in his fleeing efforts…

—Of course not, my Lord— she immediately assured him.

—In that case…— he began, a wicked smile on his lips. —You wouldn't mind being the one to decide his punishment, would you?

She couldn't help opening her eyes wide and immediately followed his gaze back to the door, where a pair of guards dragged the King in.

He had been recaptured so soon… How could it be!?

She looked back at Hordak, mustering all her calmness to pretend she was unfazed by the scene, and asked —Excuse me, my Lord, what do you mean by deciding his punishment?

He joined both hands on his lap and tilted his head to the side, explaining —It's quite easy. Evaluate whether you can extract any more information for the prisoner or decide how to dispose of him.

It was a test.

She didn't really have a choice.

If she tried to argue there was more information he could give them but returned with nothing, it'd be an immediate death sentence for them both.

But if she chose to "dispose of him", she'd have to decide on a punishment hard enough, lest she was considered to be too lenient with him, which would raise suspicions again.

Hence, she had only *one* option: Hordak's preferred punishment.

—No, my Lord— she had to admit, lowering her head. —There is nothing more this prisoner can provide us with.

—So, what will you do with him?— he calmly asked, proving it was merely a test.

—He shall be sent to Beast Island— she sentenced, fists tightly closed as she resisted showing any emotion.

—Perfect— he replied, smirking.

The King, however, had no idea what that meant and could only stare at Shadow Weaver, guessing it wasn't good. Whatever it was, he had no doubt: he had been betrayed. She had chosen to dispose of him.

When she turned around to look at him, her sorrow was visible through her mask, but Micah wouldn't see it, feeling like a fool for believing in her.

—Traitor!— he suddenly yelled. —Monster! Heartless monster!

The King was dragged away once more and immediately put in a transport to Beast Island, never to return, as they all knew.

As soon as Light Spinner arrived at her room, she fell on her knees and let her mask fall, both the literal and the metaphorical ones. Her hands shook uncontrollably, and her eyes felt like burning, already teary despite her efforts to keep that from happening.

Eventually, she managed to crawl all the way to her bed and lay down, finally letting her tears fall, and feeling like a monster once again.

In the silence of her room, she kept remembering the whole sequence, her own words, and Micah's yelling.

He was right, she had betrayed the only one that dared believe her, and sent him to a guaranteed death.

How could she!?

How could she put her façade before his life!?

Still crying, the woman breathed out slowly, regretting ever coming up with such a complicated plan. Cursing her pride, which had her believe she could easily take the Horde down from the inside.

It had only taken *her* down.

Light Spinner was no more. How could she continue to exist if she had now crossed the line!?

No. Shadow Weaver was all there was from now on…

Chapter End Notes

That was chapter 3, everyone!

I, eh, hope it didn't hurt much <("^_^)

See you tomorrow with ch 4!

Beneath The Mask

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Years passed since Micah was sent to die in Beast Island, and Shadow Weaver's heart hardened. She had decided to bury Light Spinner for good and resigned to her new identity, for which she had sacrificed so much. After all, she had no escape, or so she thought for many years.

Eventually, she ended up raising a few kids, among which two stood out: Adora and Catra.

She knew she couldn't, and shouldn't, make their lives comfortable at the Horde.

Not only was Shadow Weaver the cruelest commanding officer at the Horde, but also, part of Light Spinner still survived and kept telling her the girls had to *hate* that place. One day, if their training was good enough, they would use it to escape from that nightmare, and perhaps even join the Rebellion.

So she decided to be even more strict with them than with the other kids. And one night, they both stole a vehicle and finally escaped. Or so she thought.

Instead, shortly after, the girls returned to the Horde, and only Adora eventually deserted the Horde to join the Rebellion as Light Spinner wanted. Yet Catra remained, and no matter what she did, the girl never even *thought* about leaving.

Shadow Weaver decided to pretend she was trying to get Adora back, not only to keep Hordak's suspicions at bay, but also because she hoped it would make Catra finally see she had to leave too. Perhaps Adora herself would be able to convince her…

But it never happened. And what's more, she eventually lost all her privileges, as Hordak had warned her. She was even sentenced to be sent to Beast Island too, cruel irony if anything. But she realized, she could still leave.

In all her years at the Horde, Light Spinner had always feared the day she would be found as the mole and had a plan for when that happened: one last bit of magic to teleport herself back to Mystacor.

—Cease her!

As soon as Shadow Weaver appeared in the middle of the Lunarium, all sorcerers within sight prepared spells to counter whatever the woman may be planning to do. However, she only fell unconscious and the sorcerers immediately imprisoned her in a cellar, within a spell that kept her contained.

By the time she recovered her consciousness, a tall woman was standing in front of her in the middle of the dark room, solely illuminated by the spell that held her.

—Where am I?— she asked with a groggy voice.

—You are in Mystacor— the woman said. —Down in a cellar, to be more specific— she added. Finally, she said —You are Shadow Weaver. The traitor who left our kingdom decades ago.

—I am… not a traitor— she coughed, barely able to speak. —It was… all a plan. I… infiltrated the Horde to… take it down from the inside.

—We have never heard of a mole inside the Horde and no one has ever provided the Rebellion with any information or help from there— she immediately replied, arms folded. —Tell the truth. Did Hordak send you?

After coughing once again, she replied —No. I escaped… I can't do anything else there. And as I said… I was never with them. I… returned because my plan failed.

Shadow Weaver finally managed to raise her sight to see the woman in front of her and recognized the crown of the Head Sorceress.

—Your plan… Whatever it was, I do not care. What I care about is why you have come here — the sorceress insisted.

However, she could only say —You are… the head of the Guild. Who are you? You look so much… like a pupil I had.

—Yes. A pupil of yours was *my brother*, whom you abandoned here the day you left— she angrily replied.

—I had to. The Horde was taking over Etheria… No one would be safe, not even Micah— Shadow Weaver argued.

—For the last time: tell me what you are doing here!

—I told you! I escaped! I have returned!

Unhappy with the answer, the Head Sorceress turned around and left, leaving the woman coughing badly.

The interrogations continued for a long time, after Shadow Weaver received proper healing, as ordered by the Head Sorceress when she realized the woman was dying. Months were spent down in the cellar as Shadow Weaver tried to convince her that she was, in fact, still Light Spinner. That way, little by little, they got to know each other and eventually opened enough for the other to trust and share her personal story.

—Castaspella… I have never asked… What is happening with the war out there?

—Right— the Head Sorceress reacted. —The Horde seems to have disappeared overnight. Something happened at the Fright Zone, a huge spaceship appeared and took Hordak away.

—Horde Prime— Shadow Weaver immediately said. —He managed to contact him. It should be good news that he's no longer here. And if Etheria still stands, it means Prime and his unfathomable army is not over us.

—It should be… good news, but… they also took Glimmer.

—Your niece…

—And right when my brother was back!

—Micah is still alive!?— she exclaimed.

—I don't know how, but yes!— she replied, smiling brightly for a second. Then her mood darkened again. —If only she hadn't been taken…

—Do not be a fool and underestimate her. She's stronger than you think— Shadow Weaver stated. —And I'm not saying this because she punched me in the face. Remember who her parents are.

—Yes, yes. I remember. I just… have a bad feeling.

Shadow Weaver couldn't help but smirk slightly and said —What a shame I have to remain a prisoner here. I can't exactly help you at all.

—As if you were able to cheer someone up.

—Fine. Maybe not that, but I'm good at distracting people from what's on their mind.

—You'd manipulate me into feeling better?— the sorceress asked, raising a brow.

—If it works, it works.

Before either of them could say anything else, a distressed sorcerer arrived to the cellar and immediately called out —Head Sorceress!

—What's going on?

She approached the sorcerer, and he said —It's your brother. The Rebellion's camp where he was staying at… it was attacked. He's unaccounted for.

—You mean…

—That's not all. Many people have been somehow… brainwashed and have some kind of chip controlling them! He seems to have been caught by that too, along with many of the remaining rebellion members!

—I will go immediately— Castaspella sentenced with absolute confidence.

—But, Head Sorceress… Alone?

She hesitated for a moment, then finally turned to Shadow Weaver and dismissed the containment spell.

—Come with me and *help us* if all you have said is true.

As soon as the sorceress nodded, Castaspella turned to leave, but was stopped by a hand grabbing her arm.

—First, I have to admit…— Shadow Weaver sighed. —*I* was the one who sent Micah to Beast Island, and for that I have never forgiven myself— she let out.

—Then make up for it— the Head Sorceress told her, frowning. —Prove your words and save him this time.

—I will.

Chapter End Notes

Ahem, so chapter 4!

I almost forgot to post it, oops!!

See you tomorrow with the last chapter!! You're in for a surprise!!

Okurege (Straggling Hair)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

As promised, Shadow Weaver proved her words and helped in everything she could, despite everyone's wariness. Once she knew about the power of the Heart of Etheria and how its activation almost destroyed the planet, she insisted she could find a way to use it safely, to free Etheria's magic, and free all the chipped. To save Micah before he could hurt others or himself…

But when the sorceresses returned with the plan to obtain the failsafe, everyone's suspicions about Shadow Weaver made it difficult to convince them of carrying out the plan. However, there were literally no other options and they *had* to try; they infiltrated Mystacor, which had been overtaken by Micah himself, and managed to find the failsafe that could let them destroy the Heart.

The only problem was the risk it carried, which Shadow Weaver had never revealed.

—If anyone knows about sacrifice, that's me— she had said, insisting there was no other way and that she was *sure* Adora would survive it.

And so, the girl took the failsafe and they all escaped from Mystacor. Barely.

It was when they arrived at the hideout that everything got out of hand.

No one wanted to speak with her at first, and it quickly exasperated Shadow Weaver, who kept trying to force the girls to talk to her. Yet having put Adora in a situation where she had no choice but to risk being killed by the failsafe, Catra was furious and almost left the place.

Fortunately, Castaspella stopped her, and tried to get the three of them to speak calmly.

—I have nothing else to tell this old woman! She's a liar!— Catra exclaimed.

—Then please, just listen to her— the Head Sorceress pleaded.

—I have nothing to tell her— Shadow Weaver sentenced, folding her arms and looking away. —If she wants to leave, then let her leave.

—Oh no, absolutely not— Castaspella said, before Catra could complain again. —If you don't tell them, I will.

—Then go ahead. I don't care— she replied, dismissive.

It only angered the girls even more, but the sorceress was so adamant about having them know, that they decided to listen to her.

—Having her as a prisoner, we spoke a lot. And the first thing you have to know is that she was a double agent for the Rebellion. Or so she tried— Castaspella began.

—And you believe that story she's been telling?— Adora asked, incredulous. —She's said that since day one, no one believes her.

—I do. As I said, we spoke a lot, and I have reasons to believe her— the sorceress continued, sparing a glance at Shadow Weaver. —And about you two, she said you weren't "children of the Horde" but rather were always destined to be from the Rebellion— she explained. Adora and Catra exchanged a surprised look and remained speechless, then stared at the woman, who refused to look back at them. —Apparently, she wanted you, Catra, to run away with Adora and join us. She treated you so… cruelly because she wanted you to hate the Horde and leave.

—But you never did— Shadow Weaver interrupted, finally looking back, and visibly angry. —Why would you stay after the way I treated you!? How weren't you convinced by Adora after so many times I sent you straight to her!?

—Because of you!

Silence.

No one knew what to say, and for a moment, there was only silence as Catra's exclamation had even quieted down everyone else in the hideout.

Shadow Weaver didn't care about the attention being on them now, and merely asked — Why?

—You would *never* understand— Catra assured her. —Because you *never* cared for us, but we *always* cared for you…

With that, the girl turned around and walked away, soon followed by Adora, who only frowned sorrowfully at Shadow Weaver.

After that, the woman was thoroughly ignored and only Castaspella interacted with her, occasionally insisting that she should still prove her words; prove she's still Light Spinner, as she claimed.

But Shadow Weaver had given up. And when everyone left, most to free the chipped while the Best Friends Squad went to destroy the Heart of Etheria, the woman stayed at the hideout, alone and drinking, mask discarded on the ground.

An absolute silence reigned, until hasty steps called her attention: Castaspella arrived at the hideout, running as fast as she could.

—The girls are in trouble!

—What!?

Shadow Weaver immediately stood up and approached the sorceress, who was trying to recover her breath.

—Glimmer appeared. She said… that there's a monster… blocking the way… and they are hurt!

—Why didn't they help!?

—Adora sent them away… I don't know. Glimmer said she did something and they lost her.

—What!?

—Glimmer and Bow came to look for me… You have to help them. Please! Catra stayed to look for her. *Alone*.

—That fool… She doesn't have the power She-Ra has… When will she understand?— Shadow Weaver angrily uttered.

—That's not the point now!

Castaspella grabbed her by the arms and shook her slightly. Looking into her eyes as if trying to mentally make her understand, the sorceress tightened her grip.

—I know, I know— she sighed. —I'll go… Do what Light Spinner would have done— she accepted, smirking. —Does that grip mean you're coming too?

The sorceress hesitated but finally nodded with absolute conviction. Between the two of them, they cast a teleportation spell that managed to find Catra in what seemed like a labyrinth.

—What are you two doing here!?— the girl exclaimed, running at them. —There's a monster nearby! And Adora can't transform!

—What!?

Shocked, Castaspella covered her mouth with both hands while Shadow Weaver looked around, trying to find a sign of where Adora could be.

—We *must* find her! She *has* to reach the Heart!

—Then *do something*! For once! Do something good for us!

The sorceress sighed and admitted —I can track her down, but I'll need help. I'm… too weak right now.

Immediately, Castaspella grabbed her hand and asked —What do we do?

—Follow my lead.

When the three of them appeared where Adora was fighting the creature, time had almost run out for her. She was about to fall unconscious, and if Catra hadn't jumped to kick the creature out of the way, the girl would have perished.

—Take her to the Heart!— Catra yelled.

But instead, Shadow Weaver used what she had left of magic to blast the creature and approached her, saying —No. You take her. Go, now.

—But…

—Catra, listen to me— the woman said, cupping Catra's face with both hands while the creature remained stunned. Without her mask, hair straggling in front of her face, the girl could see her sorrowful expression as she told her —It's already too late for me. But for you? This is just the beginning… And I'm proud of whom you've become.

—No, no. Don't do this.

—Go!— Shadow Weaver insisted, letting go of her and facing the creature that had just risen above them. She cast a shield and stopped its charging, but Catra wouldn't leave. —Run! Now!

Hesitant, the girl looked back and forth between her and Adora, who was being held up by Castaspella, and finally ran towards them. She carefully took Adora from the sorceress and held her firmly.

—Go. We know you can do it— Castaspella assured them.

However, before leaving, Catra pleaded —Protect her.

They both looked at Shadow Weaver, who kept blasting the creature while yelling at them to run.

As the girls finally left the chamber towards the Heart, Castaspella ran back to the sorceress who was channeling all her power. And as soon as she realized what Shadow Weaver was doing, her instinctual reaction was to cast the first protection spell that came to mind.

An incredible explosion shook the place, destroyed the creature, and called Catra and Adora's attention. But they soon saw two figures still standing in the middle of the chamber, and breathed out a sigh.

She was fine. They were fine. They could continue on their way to the Heart.

Exhausted, the sorceresses helped each other out of that place and back to the hideout, repeating over and over again that the girls would make it.

They would save them all.

Chapter End Notes

Well, this was all for this fic, my readers.

Thank you all for reading, for giving this fic a chance, and I really hope you enjoyed it all.

This SW isn't like what I'm used to write because it's not the usual vengeful SW that joins whoever is convenient, but rather more of a sorrowful LS that only wanted the best for Etheria… Like, in the show LS only wanted the best for Etheria, yes, but she was betrayed (*felt* betrayed) and became so vengeful, became the SW we know

So, nothing, it was a new experience, writing this
So, thank you for accompanying me with this experiment! See you in my other fics if so you want!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!